



Arolygiaeth Gofal
Cymru
Care Inspectorate
Wales

Inspection Report

Seren Support Services Ltd (Cwm Taf)



Llewellyn House, Harbourside Business Park , Harbourside Road , Port Talbot , SA13 1SB



03003035345



www.seren.wales

Date(s) of inspection visit(s):

30/05/2025, 04/06/2025, 05/06/2025,
06/06/2025 13/06/2025 20/06/2025

Service Information:

Operated by:	Seren Support Services Ltd
Care Type:	Domiciliary Support Service
Provision for:	Supported Living
Registered places:	0
Main language(s):	English
Promotion of Welsh language and culture:	The service provider makes an effort to promote the use of the Welsh language and culture, or is working towards a bilingual service.

Ratings:



Well-being

Good



Care & Support

Good



Leadership & Management

Good

Summary:

Seren Support Services Ltd is a domiciliary care service who provide social, person-centred, and practical care to adults over the age of 18 with a variety of needs, with the aim of empowering individuals to remain in their own homes and lead independent and fulfilling lives. It is based in the Cwm Taf Morgannwg Regional partnership area.

People receive good care and support from the service which enhances their overall wellbeing. They have plans detailing their individual care needs and personal outcomes. These are reviewed regularly, and involve people and others involved in their care. People and their representatives are very complimentary about the positive relationships they have with care staff and the management team. Some staff feel well supported, confident and happy in their roles. Regular one to one supervision, monitoring, team meetings, and access to services to support their own wellbeing is provided for staff across the service. A variety of both mandatory and specialist training is also provided for staff both online and face to face. Staff speak highly of the dedicated trainer employed by the provider. There are robust systems in place for monitoring and reviewing the quality of the service. The responsible individual (RI) visits the service regularly and has good oversight of service provision. The service has put measures in place and made real progress in areas identified as requiring improvement at our last inspection, including around call times and rostering. The service remains open to continued work in these areas.

Findings:



Well-being

Good

People are supported to have as much control as possible over their day-to day lives. The service carries out thorough pre-admission assessments to ensure it can meet people's needs, which are evident on people's care files. People and their representatives are involved in developing and reviewing their care plans and identifying personal goals/outcomes. People's wellbeing and safety is prioritised by identifying and managing potential risks in personalised risk assessments.

Documentation such as a statement of purpose and written guide are available to people and provide information on the service, how to raise a complaint, and details of advocacy services. The management team deals with any complaints and follows the provider's policies and procedures. People's communication needs are considered in pre-assessments and care plans are evident on people's care files. Staff receive mandatory and core training appropriate to the needs of the people they support. The service is working towards anticipating, identifying, and meeting the Welsh language and cultural needs of people who use the service. A Welsh language policy is in place and Welsh language training can be sourced for staff who request it. Welsh Language Assessments are evident on care files. Documentation is also available in Welsh and one service user's care plans were seen in both English and Welsh on their care file.

People are protected from abuse and neglect. Care staff are recruited in line with regulation to ensure they are suitable to work with vulnerable people. Care staff receive training appropriate to the needs of the people they support, and staff we spoke to understand and follow the Wales Safeguarding Procedures. There are effective mechanisms in place to ensure people can voice their concerns. Risk assessments highlight any areas of concern. There are measures in place to ensure medication is safely managed and administered.

People are supported to maintain and sustain relationships with family, friends, and important people in their lives as far as possible. An example of this is the PASS application that enables people and family members to have access to information such as rotas, notes and communicate with the service. One relative spoke of how helpful this was in enabling them to "*work together*" with the service to support their loved ones, particularly as they did not live locally.



Care & Support

Good

People receive good quality care and support which helps them achieve their personal outcomes. A detailed assessment is completed prior to a person starting with the service to ensure the service can meet their needs. A personal plan is developed with the person and if appropriate, their representatives. These are consistent, person-centred, and highlight people's personal outcomes with the best ways of supporting people to achieve them. Risk assessments consider risks to people's health and wellbeing and ways for keeping people safe. We saw personal plans are reviewed regularly with people and those involved in their care to ensure information recorded remains relevant and meaningful.

People are supported by skilled staff who have a good understanding of their individual needs and preferences. There is a stable staff team which provides continuity of care to people. Care staff and the management team have very positive relationships with the people they support and their representatives. Some feedback from people included: *"The staff are fantastic"* *"Brilliant...treat me with respect"* and *"Full of life and fun"*. Relatives we spoke to describe the staff as *"Outstanding"* and *"Go above and beyond."* Another said of their loved one's carer *"The most amazing, incredible carer, delightful, exceptional, really intuitive...we thank our lucky stars they came into our lives."* And again, of the management team: *"Pro-active, responsive, optimising, and solution focussed."*

People are supported with their medication if required, and in reducing the risks of infection in accordance with national guidelines and service policy. Medication management procedures are robust, and an electronic system generally works well to minimise risks and errors. There are policies aligned with best practice guidance and care staff receive training and competency checks to ensure they remain sufficiently skilled. Routine medication and infection control audits ensure practice remains safe and effective. The risks of infection are reduced and managed as staff understand and implement safe practices to prevent infection including the appropriate use of personal protective equipment (PPE) like masks, gloves and aprons as required, and good hand hygiene.



Leadership & Management

Good

People achieve their personal outcomes because the service makes sure there are enough suitably qualified and trained staff to deliver quality care and support. Staff receive a mix of mandatory and core training relevant to the needs of the people they care for, and compliance with training is high. Staff we spoke to say the quality of the training they receive is very good and gives them the skills and knowledge to carry out their jobs well. They spoke highly of the dedicated trainer employed by the provider. The service has also developed additional Guides to support staff including 'A Guide to Food Preparation and Storage', 'Basic Welsh Language Skills', 'Recognising Early Signs of Illness', 'A Care Professional's Guide to Supporting People with Dementia', and 'Caring For Me- A Dementia Support Guide'- a tool completed and evident on some people's care files.

Some staff say they feel well supported with one staff member stating: "*Brilliant with me...very accommodating*" and describing how they have received video 'check in' calls from one of the managers in addition to formal supervision. Others describe the manager as "*Good,*" "*Approachable, supportive.*" Staff receive regular one to one supervision, an annual appraisal, and attend regular team meetings. Other incentives in place include an Employee Wellbeing Programme and an Application where staff can access information and wellbeing support. They also have access to a personal trainer that some staff told us they use to develop exercise programmes and diet plans. The service has developed a 'Communication Board' to help improve communication with both people and staff and address any issues or concerns.

Strict selection and vetting processes ensure staff are qualified, trustworthy and suitably fit to work at the service. Staff recruitment files sampled contain all the regulatory required information including references from previous employers, full employment histories, and Disclosure and Barring Service (DBS) checks. Care staff complete a structured induction when they commence employment including training and shadowing other staff. Staff are registered with Social Care Wales (SCW) as appropriate, which is done to ensure they have the skills and qualifications needed for working in the care sector.

The provider's oversight and governance arrangements foster a positive compassionate culture in the service. They engage commissioners, other professionals, staff, and people in quality assurance processes and we saw evidence of a Quality Assurance Report, Employee Engagement Survey, and Employee Wellbeing Survey. We saw audits are routinely completed in areas such as MAR charts, Care files (plans, notes, reviews), and staff supervision with a new electronic system identifying any patterns and trends so measures can be put in place to address any issues. Records confirmed the RI visits the service regularly, speaks to people and staff, and has good oversight of service delivery. Quality of care reviews are completed every six months to assess the quality of the care and support provided at the service and identify areas where improvements can be made. The service has put measures in place and made progress in addressing areas for improvement identified at our last inspection. This includes employing an additional scheduler and having a nominated person for Electronic Care Monitoring. The service is open to ongoing

improvements and strengthening work in these areas such as scheduling and rostering care calls, sufficient travel time and rest breaks for staff, and improving communication with people and staff. People and their families told us they feel confident raising any concerns with staff or the management team. The service also ensures timely notifications are sent to relevant authorities in the event of significant incidents. Service policies and procedures provide guidance to staff and ensure practice remains safe and effective. A sample we saw are aligned with statutory and best practice guidance, kept under review and updated when necessary.

Areas identified for improvement

Where we identify **Areas for Improvement** but we have not found outcomes for people to be at immediate or significant risk, we discuss these with the provider. We expect the provider to take action and we will follow this up at the next inspection.

Where we find outcomes for people **require significant improvement** and/or there is risk to people's well-being we identify areas for **Priority Action**. In these circumstances we issue a Priority Action Notice(s) to the Provider, and they must take immediate steps to make improvements. We will inspect again within six months to check improvements have been made and outcomes for people have improved.

CIW has no areas for improvement identified following this inspection.

CIW has not issued any Priority action notices following this inspection.

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